PART - A

Language Proficiency

(Expected Answering Time : 20 Minutes)

(Questions 1 to 3)

Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.

The Chinese have the most complete records of the cycles of the comets. Manuscripts from 467 B.C. first mention the appearance of Halley's Comet, and later records note each subsequent return. We can be sure that in 1066, the Chinese astronomers were recording the details of the comet's appearance.

In England in 1066, the Normans and the Anglo-Saxons were preparing to fight a decisive battle for control of the country, the Battle of Hastings. The two groups were struggling to determine which language, culture, and leadership would rule England. It was a bleak year for the Anglo-Saxons, as they were losing both the military and the political struggles. Halley's Comet appeared during the time when they were losing control of the country. Perhaps it seemed like a very unlucky sign to them. The appearance of the comet is recorded in written history and also in picture form in the great Bayeux tapestry of the 11th century, a woven story of the Norman conquest.

In Chaco Canyon, the people were going about life as usual when the comet passed by. Women were making pottery, tending children, grinding corn, and gathering berries. Men were hunting, building walls, and planning the religious festivals of the pueblo. The appearance of the comet most certainly amazed them as it lit up both the day and night sky.

1. The main idea of the passage is
   (1) the war between the Normans and the Anglo-Saxons.
   (2) the deep interest of the Chinese in Astronomy.
   (3) the appearance of Halley's Comet.
   (4) the events that occurred in 1066.

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2. The significance of the war between the Norman-Anglo-Saxons was
   (1) the victory of the Normans.
   (2) the Battle of Hastings was fought.
   (3) it involved control of England.
   (4) it was a bleak year for the Anglo-Saxons.

3. Pick out the idea which is NOT expressed in the passage.
   (1) The appearance of Halley's Comet was first mentioned in 467 B.C.
   (2) Halley's appearance is recorded on a piece of cloth.
   (3) Halley's appearance is also recorded on pottery.
   (4) Halley's appearance lit up the sky both in the day and night.

(Questions 4 to 6)

The following sentences have an error in one part of the sentence. Find the part (1, 2, 3, 4) **which has the error.**

4. (1) Each one in the group were given (2) the certificate of merit as (3) they performed (4) very well in the competition.

5. (1) Being a short vacation (2) Vanita had to return (3) without visiting (4) many of the places.

6. (1) Never I have listened (2) to such beautiful music (3) as the piece we heard on the radio (4) last night.

7. **Choose the word that cannot be the opposite of any word given below.**
   (1) Mislead
   (2) Misunderstand
   (3) Mischief
   (4) Misfortune

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